How does this method comparatively perform? Table 17.3 compares it to the three “pure” solutions: it manages to get the best of all the possible strategies, and drives the average cost down with all choices for α.

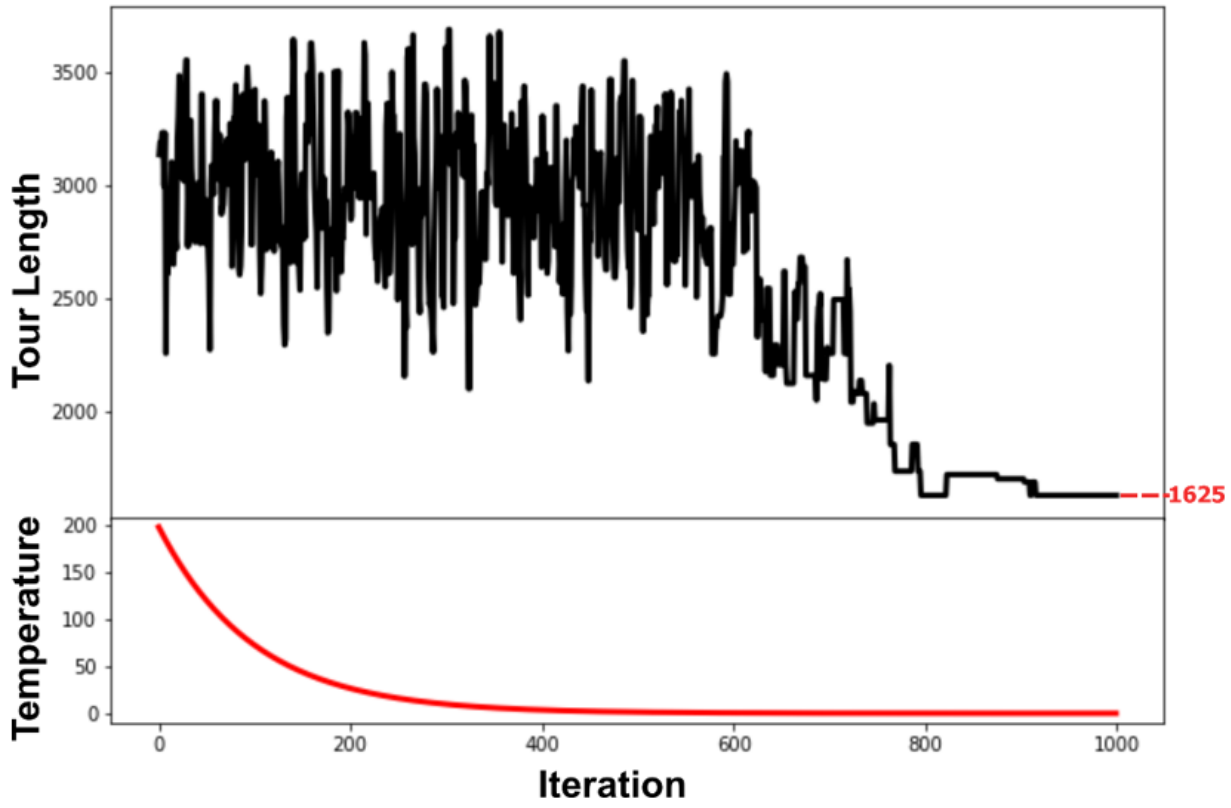


Figure 17.12 A run of simulated annealing for K10 TSP. It takes a while, but finally finds the path to global minimum.

This seems to suggest that an ensemble method, with the right ratio between the long and distant local searches, can leverage the strengths of both type of transition heuristics.

The best result, with the ensemble method, is obtained with a larger decay rate, so with a more uniform cooling process.